PEARSON EDEXCEL GCSE (9–1) HISTORY MARK SCHEME

2022 Exam-Style Practice Paper

Paper 3: Conflict at Home and Abroad: the USA, 1954–75 (1HI0/33)

Question 1: Inference from Source A (4 Marks)

Target: AO3 (4 marks). Award 1 mark for each valid inference, up to 2. Award 1 mark for each corresponding quote/detail, up to 2.

Sample Acceptable Inferences (the dangers faced by US soldiers during search-and-destroy operations in Vietnam):

• **Inference 1:** American soldiers faced persistent, hidden threats that caused continuous psychological stress.

- *Detail from source:* "The threat was constant and invisible. Every step was stressful due to booby traps and hidden mines."

• **Inference 2:** Frustration and intense combat during operations frequently led US troops to destroy civilian homes.

- *Detail from source:* "search-and-destroy operations frequently led to soldiers burning down civilian dwellings, despite regulations prohibiting it."

Question 2: Causal Explanation (12 Marks)

> **Target:** AO1/AO2 (12 marks). Level 4 (10–12 marks): An analytical explanation showing a line of reasoning with clear links to the outcome, supported by accurate, detailed knowledge.

"One reason why there was opposition to the war in Vietnam in the years 1965–72 was the unfairness of the draft system." The selective service system called up young men, particularly working-class and Black Americans who could not access college deferments, to fight in a dangerous conflict. The draft led to high-profile resistance, including Muhammad Ali refusing to serve and students burning draft cards. *Therefore, the draft system was a primary cause of opposition to the war because it directly threatened the lives of young Americans, sparking massive student-led anti-war protests.*

"A second reason why there was opposition to the war in Vietnam in the years 1965–72 was the unprecedented television and media coverage of the conflict." Unlike previous wars, the media broadcasted graphic footage of combat, such as the use of **Napalm** and the devastation of the **Tet Offensive** in 1968, directly into American living rooms. This coverage exposed the brutality of the war and created a severe **credibility gap** between government promises and the reality on the ground. *Therefore, media coverage was a crucial cause of opposition to the war because it turned public opinion against the conflict by exposing the human cost and showing that victory was unlikely.*

"A third reason why there was opposition to the war in Vietnam in the years 1965–72 was the shock of events that exposed military atrocities." The revelation of the **My Lai Massacre** in 1969, where US soldiers murdered over 300 unarmed South Vietnamese civilians, horrified the public. This atrocity, alongside the leaking of the **Pentagon Papers** in 1971, proved that the government had lied about the war's progress and methods. *Therefore, the exposure of military atrocities and lies was a key cause of opposition to the war because it undermined the moral justification for US involvement, uniting moderates and radicals in demanding withdrawal.*

Question 3(a): Source Utility (8 Marks)

Target: AO3 (8 marks). Assess content utility, verify with contextual knowledge, and evaluate provenance reliability and limitations for BOTH sources.

Source B is highly useful for showing the Black Panthers' method of armed community monitoring. Seale describes how they patrolled Oakland carrying weapons openly to monitor the police and prevent brutality, exercising their legal rights for self-defense. This content's utility is supported by my knowledge that Huey Newton and Bobby Seale formed the party in 1966 in response to police racism, using California's open-carry laws to patrol police stops, which successfully drew attention and members to their cause. The provenance of a retrospective interview with co-founder Bobby Seale in 1988 makes the source highly useful because it provides an insider's explanation of their early militant strategy. However, as an interview recorded decades later, it may present a polished, defensive narrative of their armed activities to downplay the group's involvement in subsequent violent shootouts.

Source C is highly useful for demonstrating the Panthers' focus on community social welfare and the 'Survival Programs.' The editorial details the success of their 'Free Breakfast for Children' program, which aimed to address the neglect of Black neighborhoods and improve student education. This content is validated by my knowledge that the Panthers established dozens of social initiatives, including free medical clinics and clothing drives, which fed over 20,000 children daily, helping them build strong local community support. The provenance increases its usefulness because it is from their official publication in 1969, representing their public outreach and how they wanted to project their image as protectors of the community. However, as party propaganda, it is limited because it glosses over the internal conflicts, illegal fundraising, and FBI surveillance (COINTELPRO) that affected the party at the time.

Question 3(b): Difference Between Interpretations (4 Marks)

Target: AO4 (4 marks). Identify the main difference of view, supported by details from both interpretations.

The main difference is that Interpretation 1 highlights the Panthers' use of **"armed self-defense and community monitoring"** which led to confrontations with police. In contrast, Interpretation 2 focuses on their social welfare methods, arguing they dedicated **"significant resources to community welfare"** such as clinics and food programs.

Question 3(c): Reason for Difference in Interpretations (4 Marks)

Target: AO4 (4 marks). Explain how the historians may have relied on different sources to reach their views.

The interpretations differ because the historians have focused on different aspects of the party's activities. Interpretation 1 is supported by Source B, which details their vehicle patrols where they carried "weapons openly" to monitor police, leading to the view that they focused on **"armed self-defense"**. Conversely, Interpretation 2 is supported by Source C, which outlines their "Free Breakfast for Children program", leading to the view that they focused on **"community welfare"**.

Question 3(d): Evaluation of Interpretation (16 Marks + 4 SPaG)

Target: AO4 (16 marks) + SPaG (4 marks). Level 4 (13–16 marks): Balanced discussion analyzing both interpretations with sustained contextual knowledge, leading to a justified judgment.

I agree to a moderate extent with Interpretation 2 that the Panthers' social welfare methods were a highly significant part of their work. The party established over **30 Survival Programs**, including free medical clinics, dental care, and clothing drives. As Source C details, their **Free Breakfast for Children** program fed thousands of kids and was praised by teachers. These programs gained them immense grassroots support in urban ghettos, showing that Interpretation 2 is correct to identify their focus on **"community welfare"**.

However, Interpretation 1 is also valid in emphasizing that their primary identity was defined by militant confrontation. The Panthers carried weapons openly during patrols, as Bobby Seale describes in Source B. This confrontational stance led to high-profile shootouts with police, such as the **1967** clash that resulted in **Huey Newton**'s arrest for manslaughter. Their armed rhetoric and Marxist ideology alarmed the authorities, leading FBI Director J. Edgar Hoover to call them the greatest threat to internal security and launch a campaign (COINTELPRO) to destroy them, which confirms Interpretation 1's focus on **"armed self-defense and community monitoring"**.

Overall, while their militant image (Interpretation 1) gained them national media attention and provoked FBI suppression, it was their survival programs (Interpretation 2) that sustained their local popularity. The community work proved that they were not just a street gang, but an organized political movement addressing the failures of the state. Therefore, Interpretation 2 provides a more accurate view of their constructive work on the ground.